SALES LESSON PLAN 07 / SOURCE MATERIAL

Follow-up & Next Steps

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Follow-up & Next Steps

Level: B1
Duration: 60 minutes
Focus: Sales vocabulary, follow-up language, next steps, professional communication

Lesson Goal

By the end of the lesson, the student will be able to:

use vocabulary related to sales follow-up;

talk about next steps after a sales meeting or call;

confirm agreements and responsibilities;

discuss deadlines and timelines;

ask for updates professionally;

write and discuss a simple follow-up message;

use appropriate expressions to move a sales opportunity forward.

1. LEAD-IN

Discuss

What usually happens after a sales meeting?

Why is it important to follow up with a customer?

What information should a salesperson send after a meeting?

How soon should a salesperson follow up?

What can happen if a salesperson doesn't follow up?

What are some possible next steps after a successful sales call?

Think about it

A customer says:

"Thank you for the presentation. We are interested in your solution. Let's discuss it internally and get back to you."

What should the salesperson do next?

2. VOCABULARY - Follow-up & Next Steps

A. Follow-up Vocabulary

Match the words with their definitions.

follow up

check in

update

recap

confirm

respond

provide

schedule

a. to give someone new information
b. to arrange a time for a meeting or call
c. to contact someone again after a previous conversation
d. to make sure something is correct or agreed
e. to give someone something they need
f. to contact someone to ask about progress
g. to answer a message or request
h. to summarize what was discussed

B. Next Steps Vocabulary

Complete the sentences with the words below.

next steps - action item - deadline - proposal - decision - approval - timeline - commitment

The customer asked us to send a new _____.

Let's agree on the _____ before we finish the meeting.

The customer needs management _____ before signing the contract.

The main _____ is to schedule a product demonstration.

We need to set a _____ for sending the documents.

The project _____ shows that implementation will begin next month.

One important _____ is for the customer to provide the necessary information.

The customer hasn't made a final _____ yet.

3. USEFUL SALES EXPRESSIONS

Following Up

I'm following up on our conversation from Monday.

I just wanted to follow up on our meeting.

I'm checking in to see if you have any questions.

I wanted to see if you had a chance to review the proposal.

I'm getting back to you regarding our previous conversation.

Recapping

Just to recap, we discussed...

To summarize, we agreed that...

As we discussed during our meeting...

We agreed on the following next steps...

Let me briefly summarize what we discussed.

Confirming

Could you confirm that?

I'd like to confirm our next meeting.

Just to confirm, you'll send us the information by Friday.

Can we confirm the deadline?

Does that sound correct?

Moving Forward

The next step is to...

Our next step will be to...

From here, we can...

We can move forward with...

Would you like to schedule the next meeting?

Shall we arrange a product demonstration?

Would it make sense to discuss this again next week?

Asking for an Update

Do you have any updates?

Have you had a chance to review the proposal?

Have you made a decision yet?

Is there any progress on this?

Do you need any additional information?

Is there anything else you need from us?

10. SPEAKING - Follow-up Call

ROLE-PLAY

Student A - Sales Representative

You had a meeting with a potential customer last week.

The customer:

liked your solution;

received your proposal;

needs to discuss it with their manager;

hasn't made a final decision;

said they would give you an update this week.

Call the customer and:

greet them professionally;

refer to the previous meeting;

check if they reviewed the proposal;

ask if they have any questions;

ask for an update;

clarify the next steps;

agree on a deadline or follow-up date;

close the conversation professionally.

ROLE-PLAY - Customer

You are interested in the product, but you need more time.

You can say:

"We're still discussing it internally."

"I have a couple of questions."

"We need to compare the options."

"We probably need another week."

"Could you send me some more information?"

"Let's schedule another call."

The salesperson must respond professionally and try to agree on a clear next step.

11. FINAL CHALLENGE - Move the Deal Forward

The customer says:

"We like your solution, but we're not ready to make a decision yet. We need to discuss it with our management team."

The salesperson must respond and:

acknowledge the situation;

ask for an update;

clarify what the customer needs;

offer additional information;

agree on a specific next step;

establish a timeline for follow-up.

Useful structure

Acknowledge > Check > Clarify > Offer > Agree > Follow up

Example:

"I understand. Have you had a chance to review the proposal with your management team? Is there any additional information you need from us? I'd be happy to send you more details. Would it make sense to schedule a short call next Tuesday to discuss your feedback?"

7. Wrap-up & Feedback

5 minutes

The teacher gives feedback on:

Grammar accuracy

Vocabulary

Pronunciation

Fluency

Professional register